



Their success was backed by robust products priced as low as ₹1,000 and going up to ₹3,500



In line with the government's push to 'Make in India', 70 per cent of the manufacturing has shifted to India



As growth slows, these brands are expanding into new product categories or focussing on exports

► INDIAN PLAYERS ARE RELYING ON VARIOUS PRODUCT CATEGORIES AND PRICE POINTS

► THEY HAD A MARKET SHARE OF NEARLY 60 PER CENT IN H1FY23 IN HEARABLE DEVICES

2021

Others: **28.1**

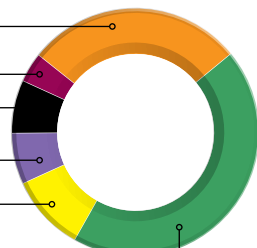
Zebronics: **4.1**

Samsung: **6.7**

realme: **6.7**

OPPO (Oppo +
OnePlus): **10.2**

Imagine Marketing (boAt): **44.2**



2022

Others: **34.9**

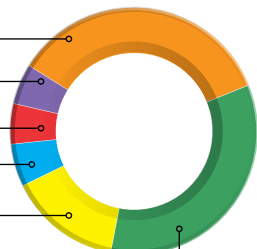
realme: **5.2**

Boult Audio: **5.4**

Nexxbase (Noise): **5.6**

OPPO (Oppo +
OnePlus): **14.7**

Imagine Marketing (boAt): **34.2**



H1CY23

Others: **32.6**

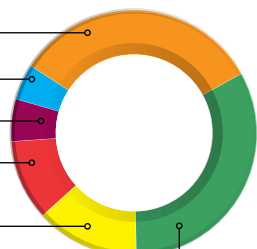
Nexxbase (Noise): **4.8**

Palred: **5.4**

Boult Audio: **10.8**

OPPO (Oppo +
OnePlus): **13.5**

Imagine Marketing (boAt): **32.9**



(Share of firms in hearable devices segment in India)

mand. They took care of the demand and sales, and we cared about the product.” After mastering the product in the next one and a half years, they started scaling up, started spending on ads, brand ambassadors and building the teams. Tying up with Amazon and Flipkart in 2019 further helped them scale up.

But scripting success in the Indian market amidst the dominance of global players hasn't been easy. Localising the products for the India market, multiple and timely launches with close price differential, along with high decibel marketing and promotion campaigns have contributed towards the sustainable run. Mehta of boAt points out that earlier, the products available in India were not customised to meet local needs. In contrast, Indian wearables brands harnessed their understanding of local consumer preferences, cultural nuances and lifestyle requirements to design products that clearly resonated with the Indian audience. One example of this is the fascination Indians have with watches. During the initial days in that segment, while Chinese players primarily concentrated on fitness bands, the Indian brands introduced budget-friendly smartwatches priced in the range of ₹1,999-3,599, which hit the sweet spot with many millennial and GenZ customers, significantly contributing to the sales numbers of the Indian brands.

Not only that, understanding the nuances of how Indians are value-conscious customers who are mindful of the quality of the products, the home-grown brands offered better features at competitive prices compared to their Chinese counterparts.

Amit Khatri, Co-founder of Noise, which started as a mobile accessories brand in 2014, and entered the smart wearables space in 2018, explains, “Our thesis was, how can we create a differentiation. Before Noise, I used to work with brands like H&M, Zara, and JCPenney, and if you look at them, they are not as cheap as some Big Bazaar products. So, there is Big Bazaar and then there are these brands on top, but there was nobody in the middle.” Fascinated by how these global brands were selling products that were designed at value pricing, Khatri decided to emulate them. “With that thesis as the key, we wanted to build something at the centre, not at the top or the bottom.”

From that standpoint, Noise started selling its smartwatch at ₹3,000, when other brands were available for as little as ₹1,000. But, with consumers willing to invest in slightly higher-priced yet feature-rich and superior-quality products, this has fuelled remarkable growth for not only Noise, but other brands